

Can I eat this? · Compass Group AI Engineer pre-work

12:40. Third in the queue.

Priya has a severe nut allergy. The menu is a laminated sheet. The allergen folder is behind the counter. The server started Monday.

She has about thirty seconds to decide if lunch is safe.

Seyi Bello · a two-tap allergen check for that exact moment

The gap, not the problem

Great data. It just doesn't reach the counter.

Compass already compiles this well upstream, PPDS syncs allergen data from the supply chain because manual tracking isn't feasible. This is what's sitting in the folder behind the counter, not in anyone's hands yet, straight from the brief's own starter menu:

Veggie chilli (vegan?)

"celery. may contain traces of nuts"

Thai green curry

"see chef"

Katsu sando (special)

"ask counter"

Fruit pot

"null"

The gap isn't the data. It's getting it to the counter live, in the thirty seconds a server actually has.

The design

Two taps. One of three honest answers.

Safe

Confirmed clean against the allergen asked about.

Unsafe

Confirmed to contain it.

Ask staff

Data is ambiguous or missing. Never guessed as safe.

Not a confidence score. A score just moves the guessing problem onto someone with thirty seconds, not the time to interpret "72% safe." "Ask staff" is the correct answer whenever the data itself doesn't support a claim of safe, and it can never be silently overridden.

Live demo

Now, on the actual app

Can I eat this?

Pick a dish, then pick an allergen. Two taps, no typing.

1. Select a dish

Chicken katsu curry £5.20	Veggie chilli (vegan?) £4.50	Margherita pizza slice £2.80	Thal green curry £5.20
Jacket potato with beans £3.95	Flapjack £1.60	Halloumi wrap £4.80	Beef lasagne £5.50
Fruit pot £2.10	Katsu sando (special) £4.95	Prawn cocktail £3.80	Fish finger sandwich £4.20
Moules marinière £6.50	Falafel wrap £4.60	Lentil dahl £4.10	Chicken satay skewers £5.10
Sausage roll £2.50	Egg fried rice £3.60	Lupin seed bread roll £1.20	Coleslaw (side) £1.80
Sticky toffee pudding £3.20	Vegetable spring rolls £2.90	Chickpea curry £4.30	Cheese & pickle sandwich £3.40
Smoked salmon bagel £5.80	Beef burger (no bun) £4.90	Tuna mayo baguette £4.10	Almond croissant £2.60

- Margherita pizza + milk → confirmed unsafe
- Veggie chilli + nuts → ask staff, not a guess
- Live at frontend-rose-three-32.vercel.app

Can I eat this?

Pick a dish, then pick an allergen. Two taps, no typing.

Can't confirm - ask staff

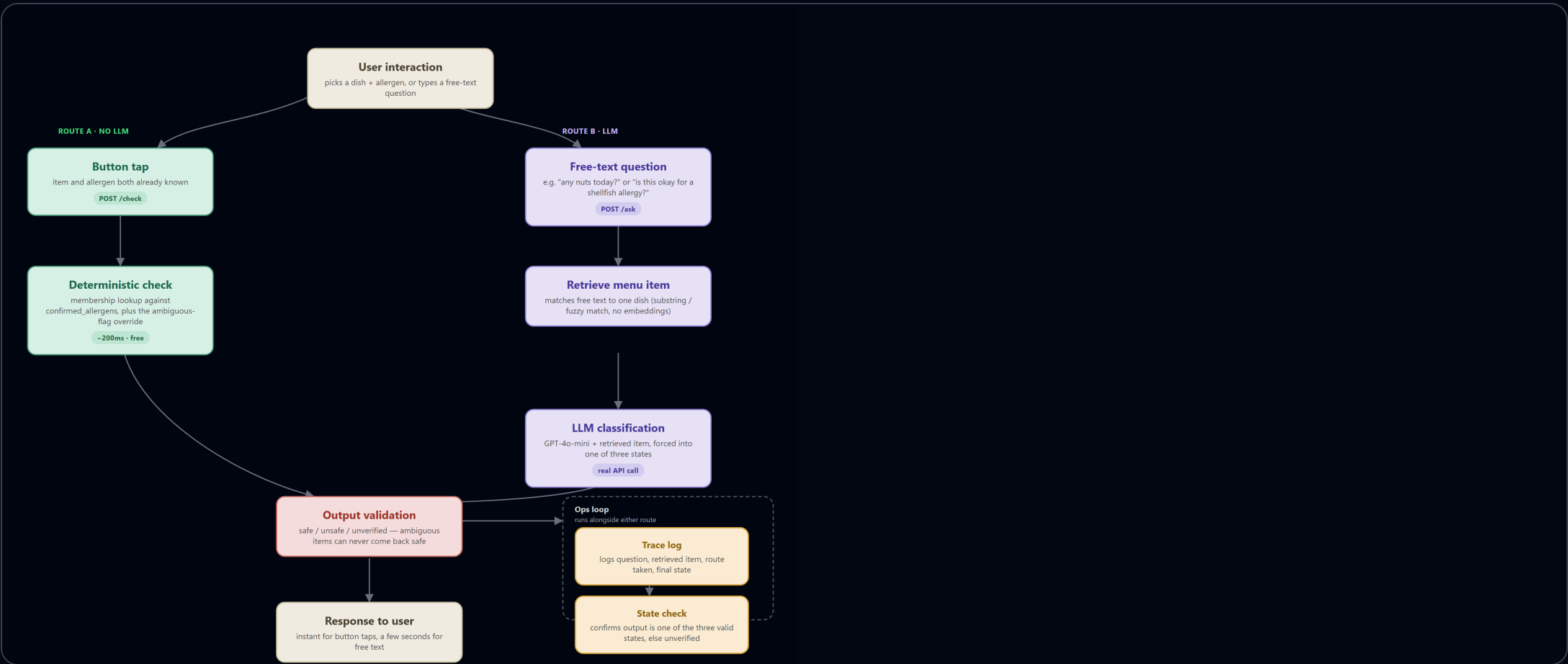
Veggie chilli (vegan?)

Menu data for 'Veggie chilli (vegan?)' is flagged ambiguous (may contain traces of nuts) - cannot confirm safe.

Ask about another allergen

New dish

Two routes. One touches an LLM.



Button taps skip the LLM entirely, a dict lookup under 200ms. GPT-4o-mini only runs for free-text questions.

The questions I expect to defend

Why these decisions, specifically

Doesn't Compass already have allergen systems?

Yes, PPDS and the Compass Allergen App handle this well upstream. Neither reaches the thirty seconds at the counter, that's the specific gap this fills.

Why not a confidence score?

It moves the guessing problem onto someone with thirty seconds. Three plain states don't.

Why not agentic, why no LangGraph or multi-agent setup?

This is one bounded classification decision, not a multi-step workflow. Agentic complexity here is tool-stacking, not creativity.

Why no vector database?

30 structured records, not a large unstructured corpus. Fuzzy string matching solves it for free, with no risk of confidently returning the wrong dish.

What I'd build next

With another week

- 01** Pull structured allergen data straight from PPDS instead of hand-curating a JSON file, Compass already compiles this per recipe
- 02** Admin auth for the rare cases where counter-level data needs a manual override
- 03** The eval, observe, diagnose, release loop, once this is serving real traffic rather than a one-off demo

[Back to Priya](#)

Thirty seconds. Two taps. One honest answer.

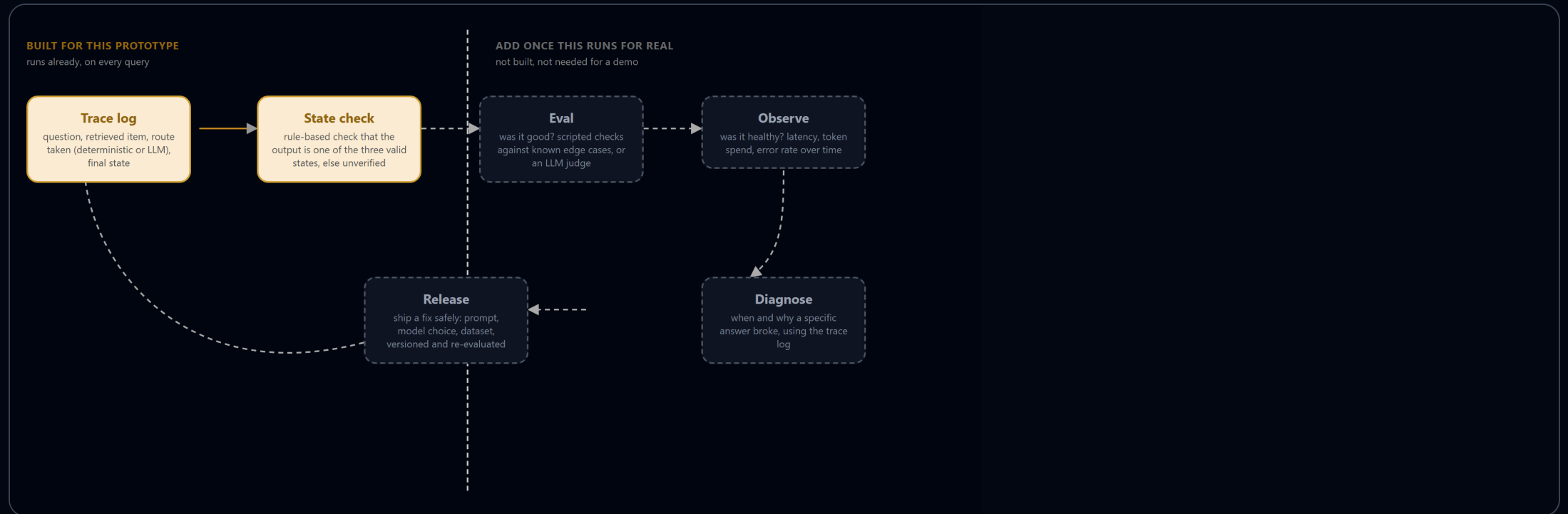
Including "ask staff" when that's the truth.

Live demo	frontend-rose-three-32.vercel.app
API	can-i-eat-this-api.fly.dev
Code	github.com/seyiabello/can-i-eat-this

Questions?

Backup slide, only if asked about production

What's next for the ops loop



What's built today (trace log, state check) versus the full evaluate/observe/diagnose/release loop, deliberately not built yet, that's solving a maintenance problem this prototype doesn't have.